

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Miss Nabiha Noor

Address: 7 Station Approach Belmont SM2 6BW

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: As a Sutton resident for over seven years, I write in strong support of Planning Application DM2025/01591. I believe this development represents a significant positive step for our evolving community.

The proposed centre will provide:

1. Community space for children, women, and men, including recreation and youth activities (social, sports, education). The planned educational activities for children and a dedicated safe space for women will provide an invaluable platform for females in the community to connect and support each other.
2. A place for community wellbeing events and positive guidance, promoting health, social connection, and personal development for residents of all ages.
3. A dedicated local space for worship.

Crucially, this venue will also be open to non-Muslims for various functions and events, and I eagerly anticipate the many other communal engagements that will be facilitated, fostering a peaceful, safe, and vibrant community for all.

The centre's location being within safe walking distance for many residents will strongly encourage locals to walk rather than drive, reducing reliance on cars and helping to strengthen neighbourhood relationships. Most attendees are expected to walk to the site.

Concerns regarding highway safety and noise levels appear to be overstated. It is important to note that the site previously operated as a 24-hour ambulance station with continuous vehicle

movements. The proposed community centre, with its clearly defined and more limited opening hours, represents a positive improvement, likely resulting in lower overall noise and activity levels compared to its previous use. Attendance will be lower than the nearby Avenue School, and peak times (e.g., Friday 1-2 pm) will not coincide with school opening/closing hours. This peak attendance already occurs at the more congested St John's Church Hall. Similarly, noise concerns are unfounded; attendees are peaceful, only soft drinks are permitted, and no music will be played, consistent with similar establishments operating hours.

I commend the responsible parking management measures described in the application, including staggering Friday prayers and avoiding school drop-off and pick-up times. This demonstrates a considerate approach to traffic management. Overall, I do not believe the proposal will cause significant traffic, light, or noise issues.

For these reasons, I respectfully urge the Council to approve Planning Application DM2025/01591, recognising the significant and diverse benefits it will bring to the local community.